

Watch The Android Show | I/O Edition 2026

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Executive summary

The Android Show: I/O Edition 2026 is a 41-minute Google livestream previewing Android updates ahead of Google I/O 2026. The keynote organizes the news around three focus areas: turning Android from an operating system into an intelligence system, elevating the core Android experience, and Android updates beyond the phone.

The main announcements are Gemini Intelligence, a new generative layer that brings proactive task automation, multimodal assistance, intelligent autofill, the Rambler keyboard feature, and generative UI to Samsung Galaxy and Google Pixel later this summer; Android 17 core upgrades including a Meta-built Instagram experience, refreshed emoji, the Pause Point digital wellbeing tool, Quick Share with AirDrop compatibility, and a wireless iOS-to-Android transfer; the next generation of Android Auto with a redesigned UI, premium in-car video and audio, the biggest Google Maps update in over a decade, and Google Built-in expansion to over 100 car models from 16 brands; and the reveal of Google Book, a new laptop category designed for Gemini Intelligence from the ground up, with partners HP, Dell, Lenovo, ASA, and ASUS.

Topics covered

Opening and intro from Sar (00:00–04:21)

The opening establishes the broadcast as the Android Show, IO Edition and frames Android as a vital part of Google’s mission in what Sar calls the agentic Gemini era.

- Sar thanks the Android community and credits millions of developers and billions of users for the platform.
- Sar frames Android as powering the devices people turn to most for information and answers.
- Sar hands off to Samir Samar, introduced as the president of the Android ecosystem.

Samir’s keynote and three focus areas (04:22–06:55)

Samir opens with momentum stats on Gemini, Google Messages, and Circle to Search, then lays out three focus areas guiding the rest of the show.

- There are now 2.5 billion RCS messages sent every single day.
- Messages across Android and iOS are getting industry-leading end-to-end encryption rolling out.
- The number of group chats across platforms has increased 116%.
- Circle to Search is used billions of times every month for outfit finding, content translation, and travel discovery.
- The three focus areas are: transforming Android from an operating system into an intelligence system; elevating the core Android experience; and Android updates beyond

the phone.

- Samir hints at a brand new category coming later in the show.

Gemini Intelligence introduction (06:55–11:46)

Mindy introduces Gemini Intelligence and walks through proactive task automation and multimodal capabilities, with the rollout starting on the most advanced Android devices.

- Gemini Intelligence brings the best of Gemini to the most advanced Android devices and is exclusive to Android.
- The rollout starts on Samsung Galaxy and Google Pixel later this summer and spans phone, watch, car, and glasses.
- Material Expressive is now infused with Gemini Intelligence and animates with purpose to signal transitions from listening to thinking to creating.
- Capabilities have been fine-tuned on Galaxy S26 and Pixel 10 devices for the past few months with hand-selected food and ride share apps.
- Mindy demonstrates multimodal capability by snapping a brochure for a coffee tasting tour in Costa Rica and asking Gemini to find a similar tour on Expedia for a group of six.
- Progress on Gemini tasks is visible live from notifications, and tasks stop as soon as they are done.
- Gemini and Chrome bring Chrome desktop automation to Android for tasks like finding a parking spot, updating shipping details, or finding an in-stock item.

Smart autofill and Rambler keyboard (11:48–14:42)

Deer demonstrates an intelligent autofill that draws on personal context already stored on the phone, then introduces a Gboard feature called Rambler that turns natural speech into structured text.

- Intelligent autofill uses Gemini personal intelligence to fill text boxes on Android apps and in Chrome.
- Deer demonstrates by autofilling passport information from a picture stored in Photos when booking a flight on a new airline.
- Autofill works across Wallet, Gmail, Photos, and more in the Google ecosystem.
- Rambler is a new Gemini Intelligence feature on Gboard that lets users speak naturally and then organizes the text and supports a revise pass for additions like emoji.
- Rambler supports code-switching between multiple languages in a single conversation through Gemini's multilingual model.

Generative UI and Create my widget (14:42–17:24)

Richie introduces generative UI on Android, starting with widgets users can describe in natural language.

- Create my widget lets users describe a widget in natural language and Gemini Intelligence generates it.
- Richie demonstrates with a widget that suggests three meal prep recipes every week that are high in protein.
- Widgets work across phone and watch — a custom weather widget displays only wind speed and rain.
- More Gemini Intelligence features will roll out later this year.

Android 17 core experience upgrades (17:29–26:25)

Gabby walks through Android 17 upgrades that improve self-expression, balance, and choice, anchored by a Meta partnership for Instagram, an emoji refresh, the Pause Point digital wellbeing tool, and a smoother iOS-to-Android transfer.

Instagram partnership and creator tools

- Google teamed up with Meta to bring the best of Instagram to the most advanced Android devices.

- Capture features include ultra HDR capture and playback, built-in stabilization, and night mode for dark concerts.
- Side-by-side tests confirm video captured and uploaded from Android flagship devices now score the same or better than the leading competitor.
- Instagram is now fully optimized for Android tablets.
- Screen reactions let users drop reactions in front of trending clips, comment sections, or shopping hauls.
- Smart Enhance reveals breathtaking detail and clarity in old photos and videos with a single tap, exclusive to Instagram's edits app on Android.
- Sound separation recognizes and separates audio layers like wind, noise, and music to boost or strip them.
- A "where's this" Android feature is coming to Pixel this summer.

Emoji refresh

- Nearly 4,000 emoji have been refined to be richer and more delightful.
- The refreshed emoji roll out later this year on Android devices starting with Pixel across apps like Gboard, YouTube and Gmail.

Digital wellbeing — Pause Point

- Pause Point gives a 10-second pause when opening an app marked as distracting.
- During the pause, users can swipe through photos that remind them of what they'd rather be doing.
- Pause Point can suggest alternative apps like an exercise tracker or audiobooks to catch boredom triggers.
- Users can have their phone require a restart before turning off Pause Point for stronger commitment.

Sharing and switching

- Quick Share is compatible with AirDrop for Android phones that have the supporting hardware.
- WhatsApp will be able to share instantly using Quick Share.
- The iOS to Android transfer process has been overhauled to wirelessly move passwords, photos, favorite apps, contacts, and even the home screen layout.
- The new transfer launches first on Samsung Galaxy and Google Pixel devices later this year.

Android Auto next generation and Google Built-in (26:35–33:30)

Skimi previews the 2026 Android Auto refresh and the expansion of Google Built-in, with a new adaptive UI, premium entertainment, and Gemini at the center of the in-car experience.

Adaptive UI and immersive navigation

- The new Android Auto experience adapts to screens of different shapes and sizes including BMW, Mini, and Lucid vehicles.
- Dashboard widgets give glanceable info while navigating, including shortcuts to favorite contacts, a one-tap garage door opener, and a weather overview.
- Immersive navigation is the biggest update to Google Maps in over a decade, with a vivid 3D view of buildings, overpasses, and terrain.
- Maps highlights critical road details like lanes and stop signs for tricky turns or merges.

Premium entertainment

- Android Auto supports video playback in supported cars later this year, including YouTube in 60 frames per second HD video.
- Videos seamlessly transition to audio when it is time to drive.
- Android Auto supports Dolby Atmos in supported apps and cars.
- Many media apps including YouTube Music and Spotify are getting visual upgrades.

Gemini in the car

- Gemini is now available in more than 250 million cars that support Android Auto.
- Gemini Intelligence is coming to Android Auto for phones that have it.
- Magic Q can read email and calendar context to send a friend the trail head address with one tap.
- Door Dash is shown as an example of ordering with Gemini in Android Auto.

Google Built-in

- Google Built-in is available in over 100 car models from 16 brands.
- Google Built-in apps include Spotify, HBO Max, and Zoom is coming soon.
- Gemini in Google Built-in cars can answer questions tailored to the actual car, such as what a dashboard symbol means or whether a 65-in TV box will fit in the trunk.
- Live lane guidance uses the car's front-facing camera to show the exact lane and guide the next move.

Google Book reveal (33:34–39:53)

Alex reveals the closing surprise — Google Book — and demonstrates Gemini-driven cursor interactions, generative widgets, cross-device app access, and partner availability.

- Over 15 years ago, Google reinvented laptops for the cloud-first world with the Chromebook.
- Google Books combine the best of Android — a modern OS with powerful apps on Google Play — and the best of Chrome OS, including the world's most popular browser and the biggest library of extensions.
- Google Books are the first laptops designed for Gemini Intelligence from the ground up.
- Magic Pointer is a new cursor that activates with a wiggle and surfaces contextual suggestions like setting up time with friends, drafting a reply, or finding meet-up spots.
- Magic Pointer is multimodal — Alex selects a photo of a nursery and a wallpaper image and a crib image, and Gemini visualizes them together.
- Create my widget is also coming to Google Books, demonstrated with a family reunion planner in Berlin that shows flights, hotel information, restaurant reservations, and a countdown.
- Google Books let users access phone apps directly on the laptop without picking up the phone, demonstrated with a Duolingo lesson.
- Quick Access lets the Google Books file browser show files on a connected phone for moments like attaching a chat-app picture to an email.
- Partners launching Google Book include HP, Dell, Lenovo, ASA, and ASUS.
- Every Google Book will be built with premium craftsmanship and identified by a unique mark called the Global.
- Google Books will be available later this year.

Closing (39:53–41:06)

Samir closes by tying the updates back to the three focus areas and pointing to the developers cut and Google IO next week.

- These updates are coming to devices with Android 17 this summer, starting with Samsung and Google Pixel.
- A developers cut of the Android show follows the main show.
- Samir invites viewers to join Google for more Android news next week at Google IO.

People, organizations, products, places

People

- Sar
- Samir
- Mindy

- Deer
- Richie
- Peter
- Gabby
- Ana
- Skimi
- Alex

Organizations

- Google
- Android
- Samsung Galaxy
- Google Pixel
- Meta
- Instagram
- Expedia
- Door Dash
- WhatsApp
- YouTube
- Gmail
- Gboard
- Chrome
- Spotify
- HBO Max
- Zoom
- BMW
- Mini
- Lucid
- HP
- Dell
- Lenovo
- ASA
- ASUS
- Duolingo

Products

- Gemini Intelligence
- Gemini
- Android 17
- Galaxy S26
- Pixel 10
- Material Expressive
- Circle to Search
- Rambler
- Create my widget
- Pause Point
- Quick Share
- AirDrop
- Smart Enhance
- Sound separation
- Pixel Perfect
- Android Auto
- Google Maps
- Magic Q
- Google Built-in
- Dolby Atmos
- YouTube Music
- Chromebook
- Chrome OS
- Google Play
- Google Book
- Magic Pointer

- Quick Access
- Global

Places

- Costa Rica
- Goa
- Berlin
- Paris

Numbers and data points

Value	Context
2.5 billion	RCS messages sent every single day
116%	increase in group chats across platforms
billions	monthly Circle to Search uses
later this summer	Gemini Intelligence rollout on Samsung Galaxy and Google Pixel
Galaxy S26 and Pixel 10	devices used for Gemini Intelligence fine-tuning
six	group size for the Costa Rica coffee tour demo
nearly 4,000	emoji refreshed for richer expression
45 minutes	example length of unintentional phone scrolling
10 seconds	pause length introduced by Pause Point
over 250 million	cars that support Android Auto where Gemini is now available
60 frames per second HD	video quality for Android Auto YouTube playback
over 100	car models that have Google Built-in
16 brands	Google Built-in availability across brands
65-in	TV box example asked of Gemini in car
60 in	interior trunk length with seats down
over 15 years ago	when Google reinvented laptops with the Chromebook
later this year	Google Book availability
this summer	Android 17 rollout starting with Samsung and Google Pixel

Notable quotes

- | Android is close to my heart. — Sar
- | Thank you to the millions of developers and billions of users for making Android what it is today. — Sar
- | In our agentic Gemini era, devices can do so much more for you. — Sar
- | There are now 2.5 billion RCS messages sent every single day. — Samir
- | Because it’s 2026 and it shouldn’t matter what kind of phone you have to text your family and friends. — Samir
- | we’re transforming Android from an operating system into an intelligence system. — Samir
- | I’m excited to introduce Gemini Intelligence. — Mindy

an intelligence system that knows what matters to you, helps you stay a step ahead, and works proactively to get things done throughout your day. — Mindy

Gemini Intelligence is here to automate the tedious stuff so you don't have to. — Mindy

Gemini has multimodal capabilities. — Mindy

we are evolving the mobile experience with a more intelligent autofill. — Deer

My phone can securely pull that information right into the app to fill out the whole form with a single tap. — Deer

Rambler is also great for people who speak multiple languages, and it works in the way that people speak, switching between them in a single conversation. — Deer

With Gemini Intelligence, we're working towards that future with generative UI. — Richie

I can just describe what I want using natural language. — Richie

this is just the beginning of how Gemini Intelligence is transforming the way that you use your devices. — Richie

we've teamed up with Meta to bring the best of Instagram to our most advanced Android devices. — Gabby

video captured and uploaded from Android flagship devices now score the same or better than the leading competitor. — Gabby

We've handrefined nearly 4,000 emoji to be richer, more delightful, and more true to how you actually express yourself. — Gabby

That's why we're introducing pause point. — Gabby

I love sharing my perfectly imperfect life with all of you with a little help from my Android. — Ana

From the very beginning, our mission for auto has been simple but powerful to make every journey more seamless, safe, and connected. — Skimi

Our biggest update to Google Maps in over a decade. — Skimi

Gemini is now available in more than 250 million cars that support Android Auto — Skimi

Google Builtin is available in over 100 car models from 16 brands — Skimi

Over 15 years ago, Google reinvented laptops for the cloud first world with the Chromebook. — Alex

Google Books are the first laptops designed for Gemini Intelligence from the ground up — Alex

That's why we call it magic pointer. — Alex

This wouldn't be a true laptop demo without pulling up a file browser. — Alex

These updates are coming to devices with Android 17 this summer, starting with Samsung and Google Pixel. — Samir

make sure you join us for even more Android news next week at Google IO. — Samir